



ViewSonic X2 Projector

Great features and performance at a reasonable price

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Projectors have been one of the silent players in the world of audio-visual technology. Most people see them as a luxury and seldom tend to be aware of how far their technology has come today. No matter how their perception may be, brands have been working day in and day out to perfect their products, as there still is a demand from the people to get their hands on the best there is. ViewSonic, a brand that is known amongst the folks of the PCMR for its monitors and displays, also has a few projectors in their lineup.

ViewSonic's X2 showed up at the Digit Test Centre in Mumbai some time back, and I spent a LOT of time trying out different kinds of content on it. From games to TV shows, the whole shebang. And it was a pleasur-

able experience for the most part. Priced at ₹1,42,999, it brings a number of features to the table and performs well. However, amongst all these hits, there were a couple of misses which bothered me. Not deal breakers, though; these things would only catch the eye of someone critically analysing its performance. Here's my account of using the ViewSonic X2, and what I thought about is performance.

Build and Design

ViewSonic X2 brings the quality one would expect from a ₹1.4 lakh rupee gadget. The materials used in the build of the outer casing of the projector are robust, the mounting points feel secure, and the projector lens is also resistant to scratching. I did not test the scratching bit, so don't worry, ViewSonic, the projector is safe. What I mean is, during day-to-day use and maintenance, the lens did not pick up and scratches and scuffs. The feet at the bottom also carry the same robust build and quality as the rest of the projector.

The only gripe that I had was that instead of giving adjustable feet, View-

Sonic went with a small flap, which you can deploy if you want to angle the projector. It does not give the user as much of freedom to experiment with the angling of the projector and engrained a sense of insecurity in me that if it breaks, I will not be able to angle my projector without sending it for repairs. That aside, there is nothing else to complain about here. The feet also held the projector well in place when I was watching shows, and the volume was pegged to the max.

As for the design, as most people going for a product would be looking at how it fits with the aesthetics of their conference room or home entertainment setup, let me assure you that it will blend in like salt in water. Thanks to its solid and sleek industrial design in my opinion, the best way to describe it is this – If you are planting it on your ceiling, then it will look like a small AC unit, and if you are putting it on a table, surround it with a couple of books, and people will pass it off as a speaker unit. To add to the second illusion, you also get the Harman Kardon branding as well!

Features and Performance

For most other products, I would keep features and performance as separate sections of their own, but with this, they converge so well that it is hard to talk about them separately.

One of the most heavily advertised features of this projector is the "3rd generation LED technology with a 30,000-hour lifespan". Now, there was no way for me to verify the claims made by ViewSonic. However, given what I have known about their products, you should expect the projector to hit these numbers with ease. The metric that I could measure was the brightness. I used our Lux meter to check whether the projector hit the claimed 3,100 LED Lumens of brightness, and it came pretty close. At about 1 metre, in an almost pitch-black room, the brightness readings were around the 3000 lumens mark, which is pretty impressive.